

Global & Regional Traditions

Bengali, Maharashtrian, South Indian, Punjabi, and a global tradition, taught by name and history

Learning Objectives

- Name and describe five regional and global bridal traditions by name and history
- Distinguish the structural and technical differences between each tradition
- Apply at least one tradition's technique on a practice model
- Explain why naming a tradition correctly, rather than generically, matters professionally

"Indian bridal" is not one look

Treating "Indian bridal" as a single generic style — the same error Course III corrected regarding global makeup traditions — erases genuine regional distinctions that matter enormously to the families who follow them. This module names five traditions precisely, by region and by technique, exactly as every earlier course's global module has done.

Bengali bridal

The Bengali bride traditionally wears a red-and-white benarasi or garad saree, a topor (a conical headpiece made of shola pith) and mukut (an ornate crown-like piece framing the face), with sandalwood paste patterns often painted on the forehead and cheeks, and alta applied to the hands and feet, connecting directly back to Course IV's alta origin story.

Maharashtrian bridal

The distinctive nauvari — a nine-yard saree draped in a dhoti-style structure quite different from the Nivi drape — is worn with a nath (a distinctive pearl-and-gold nose ring) and a mundavalya, strings of pearls hung along the hairline framing the forehead.

South Indian bridal

A Tamil or Kerala bride traditionally wears a Kanjeevaram silk saree in rich gold-bordered colour, layered temple jewelry with intricate goldwork, and a long, fragrant jasmine gajra woven through the hair — the same gajra technique taught by name in Course II's global braiding module.

Punjabi bridal

A Punjabi Sikh bride traditionally wears red and white chooda bangles gifted by her maternal uncle, gold kalire ornaments hung from the chooda, and often a phulkari dupatta with its distinctive vibrant embroidery.

A global tradition: the Chinese Qun Kwa

The Qun Kwa is a traditional red-and-gold two-piece Chinese wedding costume, richly embroidered with dragon and phoenix motifs symbolising the union of husband and wife, traditionally paired with an elaborate gold headpiece and a face partially veiled during specific ceremony moments — a tradition worth knowing by name for any Atelier serving a genuinely global clientele.

Key Terms

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[object Object]

1

[object Object]

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Practical Activity · Recreate a Tradition

Choose one named tradition from this module and recreate its distinguishing element — the drape, the headpiece, or the jewelry placement — on a practice model, labelling each element by its correct name. **Photograph the result for your capstone portfolio.**